Sources



Figure 9.20 Sources of Manganese

Manganese is universally distributed in plant and animal tissues, nuts, cereals and vegetables. The average diet can provide approximately 3 to 4 mg of manganese.Tea is exceptionally rich in manganese.

Absorption and excretion

Manganese is readily absorbed in the small intestine. Normally 3 to 4 % of Manganese in diet is absorbed. Large quantity of Manganese is excreted mostly in the feces. Only very small quantities of manganese are excreted in the urine.

Factors affecting absorption:

Manganese absorption is inhibited by iron.

Deficiency

A deficiency of Mn reduces appreciably the synthesis of oligosaccharides.

The deficiency of Manganese leads to impaired growth and skeletal abnormalities.

9.3.8. Chromium

Chromium is widely distributed throughout the body. The adult human body contains only 6 mg of chromium.

Functions

Chromium accelerates the utilization of glucose.

It reduces serum cholesterol level.

Chromium is also said to be important in the metabolism of plasma lipoproteins.

Sources

Chromium is highly available in average diets. Significant amount of chromium is obtained in the diet by cooking foods in steel containers.

Absorption and excretion:

It is absorbed in the small intestine. Chromium is mainly excreted in urine.

Deficiency

Chromium deficiency is characterized by impaired growth, weight loss and disturbances in glucose, lipid and protein metabolism.

9.3.9. Molybdenum

Molybdenum occurs in traces in the human body.Molybdenum occurs in some hemoflavo proteins.

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